

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

Infant and fetal neuroanatomy shows a well-established brain stem and cerebellum at birth. In contrast, the cerebral cortex, especially its association areas and the prefrontal region, undergoes prolonged postnatal development—synaptogenesis, pruning, and myelination occur largely in the second half of gestation and extend into childhood. Sensory and primary motor cortices and the basal ganglia are relatively more developed than the associational cortex, and subcortical structures like the thalamus, hypothalamus, and limbic system are functionally active early, though not fully mature. The parietal lobe is more developed than the frontal, and the visual system is functional at birth. Because the cortex—especially the frontal lobe—is least developed and most immature at birth—this is the correct choice.

Correct answer: C. frontal lobe

</think>

<answer>

C. frontal lobe

</answer>

